

INTRODUCTION

Saal 2016 , ek aisa saal jise hum Indian fans kafi cheejo ke liye yaad rakhte , phir chahe woh Virat Kohli ka over the top form ho, ya phir India ka tests mein no1 banna . Lekin woh saal jitna hamari Indian team ke liye khaas tha, usse 1000x guna jyada ek dusri team ke liye woh special tha.....”The Mighty West Indies”

[clips of west indies playing 2016 t20 worldcup + clips of winning the U18 world cup + womens world cup]

Ek aisi team jisme ek se badhkar ek players bhare hue the , ek aisi team jisne na keval mens t20 world cup ko jeeta balki U18 world cup aur womens world cup ko bhi jeeta tha. Jaha pe koi bhi team ek t20 world cup jeetne mein apni jee jaan laga deti hai, vahi in that year West Indies won 3/3.....Aur isme sabse maze ki baat yeh hai ki kisi bhi 3 tournaments mein West Indies favourites tak nahi thi....espeacially in 2016 MENS T20 WORLD CUP !

Isliye aaj ki is video mein hum yahi dekhege ki kaise na keval West Indies ne apna dusra t20 world cup jeeta , balki aisa kuch kar diya jise aaj bhi hum cricket fans use ek iconic world cup campaign ki tarah dekhte hai.

CH1 : Pre world cup scenario

Agar ek normal team ki baat kare toh kisi bhi bade ICC tournament se pehle pura cricket board aur management player selection se leke complete preparation mein involve ho jate hai kyuki obviously T20 cricket ka sabse bada taaj aakhir kon nahi pehna chahega....lekin aisa kuch West Indies ke saath nahi tha. Infact is T20World cup se pehle West Indies ko favourite tak consider nahi kara jaa raha tha. Jaha pe baaki teams apni preparations kar rahi thi vahi pe West indies cricket team mein apne alag hi internal conflicts chal rahe the unke board se. Phir chahe woh unfair committee selections ko lekar ko ya phir players ke unfair pay ko lekar. Puri west Indies team bikhar chuki thi and even 2014 ke beech India tour mein West Indies ke star players like Pollard and Andre Russel already beech tour chood chuke the. Isliye jab yeh West Indies team 2016 ka t20wc khelne utri toh kisi ne bhi nahi socha tha ki yeh team semi finals tak bhi jaa sakti hai. And phir jo uske baad hua woh batata hai kyu West Indies ki team ek actual world champion thi....

Ab agar thoda sa detail mein dekhe toh West Indies ki preparation bilkul normal nahi thi. Jaha baaki teams centralized camps, fixed combinations aur long-term planning pe kaam kar rahi thi, wahi West Indies ke players zyada tar alag-alag T20 leagues khelkar aa rahe the. Chris Gayle, Andre Russell, Pollard, Bravo — yeh sab players saal bhar IPL, CPL, BBL jaise tournaments mein pressure situations khel chuke the. Matlab jab baaki teams T20 ko abhi bhi “shorter version of ODI” jaise treat kar rahi thi, West Indies ke players ke liye T20 ek separate format tha, jisme risk lena, six maarna aur fail hona normal tha.

Aur yahi difference unke preparation ka sabse bada advantage banke gaya. Chris Gayle , Andre Russel , Kieron Pollard or Sunil Narine aise players hai jo na keval IPL mein apni apni teams mein dominate karte hai balki yeh aaj bhi franchise league cricket mein greatest consider kare jaa sakte hai. West Indies

ke players ko pata tha ki unka selection average ya consistency pe nahi, balki impact pe hone wala hai. West Indies ke batsman ko average ka dar nahi tha infact all the players were ahead of their time in t20 cricket. Jaisi hard hitting approach aajkal t20 mein aa gayi hai....vaisi mentality and approach woh players pehle se hi 2016 mein leke aa gaye the. Aur T20 cricket mein jab darr nikal jaata hai, tab batting dangerous ho jaati hai.

CH2 : Squad, Strengths aur Weaknesses

Agar 2016 West Indies squad ko paper pe dekha jaaye, toh kaafi logon ko lagta tha ki yeh team unstable hai. Top order unpredictable, bowling thodi inconsistent, aur fielding bhi kabhi kabhi average. Lekin jo cheez paper pe weakness lag rahi thi, wahi ground pe unki strength ban gayi. Team ke paas batting depth thi No. 8 tak. Gayle, Simmons, Samuels, Russell, Pollard, Bravo — matlab kisi bhi over mein match palat sakta tha.

Bowling mein bhi unka approach simple thi. Sunil Narine aur Samuel Badree jaise spinners middle overs mein run rokte the, jabki Andre Russell aur Bravo death overs specialist the. Us puri squad mein Sabse important cheez thi role clarity. Jaha pe Chris Gayle first ball se pura momentum West Indies ki taraf shift kar dete the vahi pe Simmons Innings ko hold krte the , and jaisa hamne is T20 world cup mein dekha tha. Samuels pressure situations handle karta tha. Russell aur Pollard finishers the. Bravo all-rounder role mein captaincy support karta tha. Kisi ko extra sochna nahi padta tha. Sabko pata tha ki unka kaam kya hai.

CH3 : Group Stages – Statement Cricket

West Indies ka group bilkul bhi easy nahi tha. Group 1 mein unke saath England, South Africa, Sri Lanka aur Afghanistan jaise teams thi. Matlab ek taraf power-packed England, doosri taraf South Africa jaisi disciplined side, aur saath mein defending champions Sri Lanka. Agar yeh group cross ho

jaata, tabhi koi team knockouts ke baare mein soch sakti thi. Aur yahin se West Indies ka actual test shuru hota hai.

Tournament ka pehla hi match tha **16 March 2016**, England ke against, Mumbai ke Wankhede Stadium mein tha. England ne pehle batting karte hue **182 runs** bana diye, jo us time ek strong total maana jaa raha tha. Lekin chase mein jo hua, woh sirf ek successful run chase nahi tha, woh ek mindset reveal tha. Chris Gayle ne **48 balls mein 100 run** bana diye. 11 chhakke, 5 chauke, strike rate 208+. Yeh century sirf scorecard ka part nahi thi, yeh ek clear message thi jaha pe England bilkul helpless ban chuke the. Gayle ne fast bowlers ko bhi same intent se maara, spinners ko bhi, aur powerplay ke har ek over ko use kiya. West Indies ne target **18.1 overs mein chase** kar liya. Us din ke baad yeh clear ho gaya ki agar West Indies ko 160–170 ke score pe rokhne ki soch rahe ho, toh woh kaafi nahi hone wala.

Is match ke baad bhi kai logon ne kaha ki yeh ek “Gayle special” tha. Lekin agla match South Africa ke against, **20 March 2016**, Nagpur mein, yeh prove karta hai ki West Indies sirf batting pe depend nahi kar rahi thi. Is match mein West Indies pehle batting karte hue sirf **138 runs** bana paayi. Normally yeh score knockout type game mein defend karna mushkil hota hai. Lekin yahin pe unka bowling aur planning ka side saamne aata hai. Sunil Narine aur Samuel Badree ne powerplay aur middle overs mein South Africa ko bilkul free nahi hone diya. AB de Villiers sirf 6 run bana paaye, aur puri South Africa team **122 pe all out** ho gayi. West Indies ne match **8 run se jeet liya**. Yeh match unki tournament journey ka turning point tha, kyunki yahin se yeh samajh aa gaya tha ki yeh team sirf maarne nahi, match close karna bhi jaanti hai.

And isi same fashion mein west indies ne apna agla match Sri Lanka ke khilaf 7 wickets se jee liya.

Halanki West Indies apna last match Afghanistan se ek thriller fashion mein haar liya but already West Indies semis ke liye asaani se qualify kar chuki thi.

CH4 : Semi-final vs India – Mindset ka Farq

Semi-final India ke against tha, aur honestly yahi woh match tha jaha poori duniya ki nazar West Indies pe tik gayi. Venue Eden Gardens tha, stadium completely packed, crowd almost pura one-sided, aur upar se India tournament mein unbeaten chal rahi thi. India ne pehle batting karte hue **192 ka score** khada kar diya, jo us time ke T20 standards ke hisaab se ek kaafi bada total maana jaata tha. Isliye normally yaha pe chasing team thodi conservative approach leti hai, kyunki early wickets gaye toh match haath se nikal sakta hai, lekin West Indies ke saath aisa kuch nahi hua.

Use pure chase ke dauran west indies ke saath jo cheez thi woh thi unki kismat. Lendl Simmons us puri chase mein sabse important part bane rahe the , lekin hum sabhi ko pata hai ki un Lendl Simmons ko ek nahi do nahi balki 3-3 baar ek lifeline mili thi jab Ashwin , Bumrah ki no balls pe woh out ho gaye the but unhe not out decalre kar diya gaya tha.. aur yahi moment match ka turning point ban jaata hai. Uske baad Simmons aur zyada freely bat karte hain, kyunki unhone scorecard ke pressure ko ignore karke sirf gaps aur boundary options pe focus kiya.

Yahin par India thoda defensive ho jaati hai, kyunki bowling mein variations miss hone lagti hain, aur death overs ke liye clear planning nazar nahi aati. Slower balls aur wide yorkers ka execution inconsistent raha, aur field placements bhi thode reactive lagne lage. Iska result yeh hua ki momentum dheere dheere West Indies ke side shift ho gaya, aur India ke paas comeback ka time kam hota chala gaya.

CH5 : Final vs England – Formula ka Peak

Final mein England ke saamne phir se West Indies thi. England ne pehle batting karte hue 155 ka score banaya, jo final ke pressure ke hisaab se defendable lag raha tha. West Indies ke liye chase easy nahi tha. Early wickets gire, run rate manageable tha, lekin pressure constantly build ho raha tha.

Yaha pe Marlon Samuels ka role crucial tha. Samuels flashy nahi khele, unhone smart cricket khela. Bowlers ko target kiya, gaps nikale, aur strike rotate ki. Aur phir aata hai woh moment jise shayad koi bhi cricket fan bhool nahi sakta — Carlos Brathwaite ke woh 4 sixes.

Yeh sirf ek over nahi tha. Yeh West Indies ke poore T20 philosophy ka summary tha. Last over mein risk lena, fear ko side mein rakhna, aur apni strength pe pura trust rakhna. Ben Stokes jaise bowler ke against bhi hesitation nahi thi. Aur jab woh last ball six boundary ke paar gayi, tab sirf ek match nahi jeeta gaya — ek era define hua.

CH6 : Legacy

2016 ke baad T20 cricket badal gaya. Teams ne realize kiya ki strike rate, intent aur depth zyada important hai. West Indies pehli team bani jo do baar T20 World Cup jeeti. Aur sirf men's nahi — women's aur U19 titles bhi jeete gaye.

Yeh world cup sirf trophies ka nahi tha, yeh approach ka world cup tha. West Indies ne dikhaya ki T20 cricket ka future fearless hai. Aur shayad isliye, 2016 ka T20 World Cup aaj bhi sirf ek tournament nahi, balki ek iconic cricketing memory ban chuka hai.